

DECEMBER 2018

End of the year is always so much fun, as you already know because you're probably reading this in December too...



SONY PATENT

We were very excited when we learnt that Sony might be working on a transparent phone

screen. Essentially two screens back to back, the idea was that a display at the back could pick up incoming light and project it onto the corresponding pixel on the front screen, or vice versa. The result? A phone display that actually looks totally transparent.

LOADS OF 5G ANNOUNCEMENTS

Many brands announced plans for 5G phones. Boy did they come rolling in... Samsung, Nokia, OnePlus, Huawei, Lenovo, Xiaomi, HTC, Vivo, Sony, LG, and more all announced something. Our news feed was buzzing with the term '5G' in December 2018.

ALLO, GOODBYE

First there were rumours that Google would shut down Hangouts, which made us worry because



we use it a lot to conference across locations. Then it was announced that it would not be shutting down Hangouts after all, yay! Then they announced they were shutting down Google Allo, and no one batted an eyelid. Goodbye Allo, and good riddance.

EARN \$22 MILLION!

Sounds just like a rogue popup ad, doesn't it? Well, in December 2018 we reported that a seven year old Toy Reviewer (Ryan ToyReview) on YouTube had earned \$22 million in 2018! With over 26 billion views back then, the 7-year old was much loved by kids from all over the world. Imagine getting to play with the latest toys to review them, AND getting paid \$22 million to do it! Sounds like the best job ever.

TECHNOLOGY DOESN'T LIE

When the police in UK received a distress call from a man reporting that his wife had been attacked and wasn't breathing, the last thing

they expected was for the husband to be the murderer. However, upon examining the health app on his phone, they found that at the time the wife was murdered, he was running up and down stairs and erratically "working out" in his own house. This evidence played an important part in convincing the jury of his guilt.



Also

- OnePlus announced plans to build an R&D centre in Bangalore
- Quora reported that data of 100 million users' was stolen by hackers
- Voyager 2 followed in Voyager 1's footsteps and entered interstellar space. Bye Voyager 2, happy journey!
- NYT report shows how even anonymous location data can be used to identify actual people and track them
- PUBG banned 30,000 players for cheating
- Google used AI to delete malware and fake reviews from the Play Store

JANUARY 2019

After what's usually a very hungover start to the new year, as life slowly trickles back into our bodies, we prepare ourselves for a month that sets the stage for an exciting year ahead.



NASA CREATES HISTORY

Just hours into the new year, the spacecraft OSIRIS-REx successfully completed

a burn to put itself into orbit around the asteroid Bennu. This feat was pretty amazing, given the fact that Bennu has a mass of about 5 millionths of Earth. However, so weak is the gravity, that it takes 62 hours to orbit Bennu!

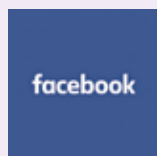
10 IS GREATER THAN 7

Yes, we know that's obvious, but before January, data suggested that 7 was greater than 10... no we haven't been drinking on the job, we're talking Windows versions here. Finally, three-and-a-half years after launch, Windows 10 pipped Windows 7 to become the most used PC operating system in the world.

BAD FACEBOOK!

Reports that came out in Jan 2019 suggested that not only was Facebook tracking their users,

but that they were tracking non-facebook users on Android as well. They were doing this by using the data that other developers provide to them via their own apps, which communicate



with the Facebook platform using its SDK. Instead of sharing data of only those users who had linked

their Facebook account to aforementioned apps, the apps were lazily just sending Facebook data of all users, as soon as the apps were launched.

CES

January is our month to cover CES Las Vegas, and boy did we have a lot happen in the 2019 edition. 8K TVs were all the rage, but LG's rollable 8K display stole the show. Readers showed a lot of interest in Kohler's \$8,000 smart toilet that did everything a luxury toilet does, including personalised cleansing and drying, a perfectly heated seat and smart flushing, etc. But, it also had Alexa inbuilt with speakers and even ambi-

ent lighting. There were loads of gaming laptops launched, including ASUS' ROG Mothership, and Dell's G7 and Alienware Area-51m, as well the Alienware M15s and M17s. There was much more, but you're probably looking forward to the 2020 edition instead. Remember to check out our live coverage of CES 2020 on digit.in in January.

Also

- An ISS astronaut accidentally dialled 911 from space
- Netflix, Hotstar and others signed an agreement to self regulate
- Samsung threatened to stop manufacturing phones in India if forced to follow the government's Phased Manufacturing Programme
- WhatsApp crashed for a bit on January 22, and users tweeted about it
- PM Modi promised that Indians would get chip-based e-passports soon
- A bug was revealed in iPhones which could cause a user who facetime'd you to listen to your audio even if you didn't answer the call!